



DANIEL CHRISTENSEN

Math Enthusiast | Developer | Problem Solver

About Me

Full-stack developer turning complex ideas into high-performance web platforms. Experienced in mentoring junior devs, guiding project teams, and delivering AI-powered and data-driven solutions across fintech, SaaS, and interactive platforms. Passionate about solving hard problems and building software that drives real business impact.



02.christensendaniel@gmail.com



+27 71 964 4819



danielchristensen.dev



Johannesburg, South Africa
(willing to relocate)

Language

- English (Proficient)
- Afrikaans (Native)
- JavaScript (Fluent)

Expertise

- Full-Stack Web Dev
- Laravel & PHP
- Django & Python
- React & Vue.js
- API Integrations
- JS & Alpine.js
- Data Visualization
- System Design

Experience

CubeZoo – Laravel Full-Stack Software Engineer

Jan 2023 – Dec 2025

Built and delivered 9+ large-scale fintech, SaaS, analytics, and AI-driven platforms using Laravel, Livewire, React, and modern JavaScript. Led projects end-to-end, mentored junior developers, managed direct client communication, and became a go-to engineer for solving complex technical challenges under pressure. Recognised with CubeZoo's "Remarkable Achievement" award for leadership, delivery speed, and consistently high engineering standards.

ProPay – Intermediate Software Developer

Jan 2026 – Present

Working across high-traffic Laravel and Livewire platforms in a fully remote Agile environment, focusing on performance optimization, legacy refactoring, scalability, and maintainable frontend architecture. Trusted to solve complex production issues, optimize large data workflows, and improve code quality across systems actively used by thousands of users.

Education

University of Johannesburg, South Africa

Bachelor of Science in Computer
Science and Mathematical Sciences
Jan 2021 - Nov 2023

Skills and Expertise

- Programming Languages: Python, JavaScript, PHP, SQL, HTML, SCSS
- Full-Stack Development: Laravel, Django, React, Vue.js, Livewire, REST APIs, Alpine.js, Tailwind, Bootstrap, MUI React
- Tools & Frameworks: Git, Docker, Livewire, Filament, GSAP, Storybook, API Integrations
- Leadership & Collaboration: Team Leadership, Developer Mentorship, Client Communication, Agile Workflows.
- Data, AI & Analytics: AI-Powered Platforms, Vectorization, Data Visualization, Statistical Analysis
- Dev & Workflow: Git, Docker, Jira, Code Reviews, Performance Profiling, Technical Documentation

EXPERIENCE

Laravel Full-Stack Software Engineer

CubeZoo | Jan 2023 – Dec 2025

I joined CubeZoo in early 2024 as a Full-Stack Laravel Developer and quickly became one of the go-to engineers for solving complex problems and delivering under pressure. In less than 2 years, I've contributed to over 9 major projects across industries – from fintech to SaaS platforms – often stepping in as a lead to drive projects from concept to launch.

My role extends far beyond coding: I've been trusted to lead teams, manage direct client communication, and mentor junior developers – ensuring not just working software, but smooth delivery and client satisfaction. I specialise in building scalable backends with Laravel and Livewire, while also crafting high-performance, animation-rich frontends with Alpine.js, React, and modern JavaScript.

Recognised with CubeZoo's "Remarkable Achievement" award, I've built a reputation for delivering results on tight deadlines while raising the standard of quality across projects.

Core Contributions

- **End-to-End Development:** Delivered full-stack solutions balancing robust architecture with sleek UI/UX.
- **Leadership & Mentorship:** Led multiple projects, coached junior developers, and streamlined team workflows.
- **Client-Facing Delivery:** Managed direct client communication, translating requirements into clear, actionable solutions.
- **Scalable Systems:** Designed subscription engines, role-based dashboards, and modular React component libraries.
- **Innovation:** Integrated AI-powered job matching features and architected data-driven platforms.

Key Achievements

- Delivered a subscription platform and multi-role dashboards for High Five Videos, unlocking new revenue streams.
- Designed a modular React dashboard system for Hartree Data Platform, enabling faster iteration and scalability.
- Integrated AI-powered job matching at CrackerJackHire, adding intelligent automation to recruitment workflows.
- Revamped CubeZoo's own website with an animation-heavy, responsive frontend that elevated brand presence.
- My focus is always on performance, scalability, and maintainability, with a strong eye for detail on user experience. More than just delivering software, I make sure the solutions I build have a lasting business impact.

Intermediate Software Developer

ProPay | Jan 2026 – Present

Joined ProPay as an Intermediate Software Developer working across multiple Agile product teams building and maintaining high-traffic Laravel, Livewire, AlpineJS, and Tailwind applications used by thousands of South African users. The role significantly strengthened my focus on performance optimization, maintainability, scalable architecture, and production-grade engineering practices within a fully remote environment.

Worked on Petra Prime, an internal management platform used by various South African political organizations, where I refactored a legacy Excel report generation system powered by complex raw SQL queries. Successfully delivered the full refactor within a week without introducing regressions, earning praise from the team lead and QA testers for reliability and execution quality.

Later transitioned full-time onto Solidariteit's social platform – a large-scale "mini Facebook"-style application – where I focused on production bug fixing, frontend improvements, performance optimization, and maintainability refactors. Regularly used Laravel Telescope, query optimization, caching strategies, and code refactoring to improve application performance and reduce unnecessary database load and model hydration.

Also led a frontend architecture cleanup initiative, restructuring a large monolithic CSS file into a modular, maintainable styling system across both the main platform and Filament admin panel. Through intensive peer reviews and architectural feedback, I developed stronger engineering discipline around writing cleaner, more scalable, and maintainable production-ready code.

NOTABLE PROJECTS

CubeZoo Website

Corporate website rebuild from scratch with Laravel and Bootstrap, later expanded into a full-screen, highly animated experience with advanced design requests.

Contributions

- Learned PHP, Laravel, and Bootstrap from scratch to deliver the site.
- Implemented full-screen redesign, new Service pages, real asset-tracking preloader, and homepage animations.
- Optimized for multi-domain deployment (.co.za & .co.uk from one codebase).
- Implemented full SEO stack and optimized page performance.
- Built custom SCSS/JS animations and interactions without external libraries.

Key achievements & impact

- Delivered pixel-perfect frontend praised by designers as the most accurate implementation they had seen.
- Boosted site performance: Google Analytics showed increased click-throughs and session duration after relaunch.
- Earned recognition from leadership for ability to balance technical skill with creative design execution.
- Strengthened skills in SEO, performance optimization, and custom JS/SCSS animation work.

 3 months

High Five Videos (Hive Platform)

Subscription-based platform connecting video editors, companies, and customers through streamlined workflows, flexible subscriptions, and robust content discovery.

Technologies: Laravel, Filament, Livewire, Bootstrap, AlpineJS, Vanilla JS, MariaDB, Minio S3.

Core features I built

- Advanced credit + subscription system with Paystack integration.
- Mini video preview players (hover on desktop, scroll on mobile) built with custom JS.
- Time-based revenue and video analytics for Editors.
- Revenue withdrawal system with secure payout workflows.
- Zero-duplicate, fully linted codebase with complete documentation.
- Pixel-perfect frontend implementation from Figma designs.

Key achievements & impact

- Delivered a high-performance, maintainable codebase that every new dev praised as the cleanest they've worked on.
- Optimised video file sizes and thumbnails for faster load speeds, improving user experience.
- Built a scalable revenue system that empowered video editors to earn and manage payouts seamlessly.
- Grew significantly in Laravel, system design, and code quality discipline.

 4 months

Hartree Data Platform

React-based data platform for global commodities trading, delivering real-time analytics, custom dashboards, and a flexible frontend component library.

My contributions

- Led the development of a React component library built with Storybook and Material UI.
- Implemented dark/light theme switcher across all sections and components.
- Designed dynamic, backend-agnostic components for seamless real-time data integration.
- Built advanced analytical graphing tools using Chart.js to simplify complex data visualisation.

Key achievements & impact

- Delivered the proof of concept and initial project quote, which the client approved without negotiation.
- Earned praise from Hartree's dev team, who admitted they lacked the frontend expertise to build at the same level.
- Produced clean, well-documented, high-performance code that set the standard for their ongoing frontend development.
- Upskilled rapidly in React, Material UI, and JavaScript, strengthening my ability to deliver dynamic, scalable frontends.

 3 months

CrackerJack Job-Match Discovery Platform

AI-powered upgrade of a legacy Laravel + Vue system into a modern job-matching platform.

Context: Legacy system (Laravel 5 + Vue 2) was brittle and outdated. I led the modernization to Laravel 12 + Vue 3, making the system maintainable and future-proof.

Contributions

- Refactored and rebuilt a portion of the frontend in Vue 3.
- Designed and implemented the AI Match Discovery engine:
- Data preparation pipelines to align employee and job data fields.
- Vectorization using a HuggingFace resume model.
- Weaviate integration to compute relevance-based job matches.
- Gemini integration for prompt-based scoring logic.

Key achievements & impact

- Successfully upgraded a 10-year-old legacy nightmare into a modern, maintainable platform.
- Built a scalable AI-driven matching system, enabling smarter job recommendations.
- Improved team productivity by removing blockers caused by legacy tech debt.
- Developed deep expertise in AI integration, data pipelines, and modernizing large-scale codebases.

 4 months

Portfolio Website

Personal developer portfolio showcasing skills, projects, and animations — built without frameworks (pure HTML, SCSS, AlpineJS, and Vanilla JS).

Key features

- GSAP animations for smooth transitions and effects.
- JS Page Router + Component Loader for dynamic navigation and rendering.
- Preloader and custom animations across all pages.
- Resend Mail integration for contact form.
- Deployed on Vercel with full GitHub branch history.

Key achievements & impact

- Proved ability to design and build a modern, interactive site without frameworks.
- Showcased frontend craftsmanship, animation skills, and minimal-dependency development.
- Strengthened ability to translate PenPot designs into a polished, production-ready site.
- Became a strong talking point with recruiters reviewing my portfolio.

 8 weekends

4Me Financial Services Platform

Interactive employee financial management and marketing platform, featuring payday advances, short-term loans, leave management, and insurance integrations.

Overview

- Marketing site fully built by me, providing a sleek, user-friendly interface for public users.
- Post-login portal enables employees to manage loans, advances, and leave requests.
- Integrated with Payspace and MyExperian (Compuload Cloud) APIs for KYC, payroll verification, and loan processing.
- Platform still under active development, with me leading the project and mentoring a newly onboarded developer.

Core contributions

- End-to-end frontend and backend development using Laravel, Livewire, Bootstrap, and AlpineJS.
- Loan application journey: Interactive loan sliders, repayment calculators, fee breakdowns, consent handling, and real-time status tracking.
- Salary advance module: Real-time earned salary tracking, advance selection, deduction previews, consent management, and progress tracking.
- Annual leave management system: Dynamic leave request flows, calendar picker, payroll integration, eligibility checks, and historical request tracking.
- Robust KYC implementation: Conditional flows for KYC capture, secure data handling, Experian integration, and POPIA/GDPR compliance.

Key achievements & impact

- Leading developer on a complex, scalable financial system, building maintainable, high-quality code for a multi-module platform.
- Mentoring junior developer to ensure consistent code quality, maintainability, and adherence to deadlines.
- Successfully integrated multiple external financial APIs to enable secure, real-time financial operations.
- Designed a modular system architecture to support fast feature expansion and long-term scalability.
- Strengthened expertise in Laravel, Livewire, API integrations, complex UI/UX flows, and secure financial software development.

 4 months

SKILLS & EXPERTISE

Full-Stack Development & Architecture

- Build scalable, maintainable web applications using Laravel, Django, React, Vue.js, and Alpine.js.
- Design modular component libraries and reusable front-end/back-end systems for rapid iteration.
- Optimize legacy systems through refactoring, performance tuning, and architectural improvements.
- Design systems with real-world production constraints in mind.

API & Data Integration

- Integrate multiple APIs including Payspace, Experian, and payment gateways for secure, real-time operations.
- Build AI-driven workflows, job-matching systems, and vectorized data pipelines.
- Handle large-scale data queries and reporting pipelines using optimised SQL and backend processing.

UI/UX & Frontend Excellence

- Deliver pixel-perfect, responsive, and animation-rich frontends using Tailwind, Bootstrap, GSAP, and Storybook.
- Architect scalable CSS systems and design structures for large applications and admin panels.

Leadership & Mentorship

- Lead project teams, mentor junior developers, and ensure high-quality code and smooth delivery.
- Manage client communication, translating requirements into actionable solutions and driving project success.

Analytics & Problem Solving

- Build dashboards and visualization tools for real-time insights and decision-making.
- Leverage strong analytical and mathematical skills to solve complex technical challenges.
- Evaluate multiple implementation strategies and select optimal solutions based on performance and maintainability trade-offs.

Innovation & AI Focus

- Develop AI-powered solutions and data-driven platforms, delivering measurable business impact.
- Continuously explore emerging technologies to optimize performance and scalability.

Performance & Optimization

- Backend performance tuning driven through profiling tools like Laravel Telescope (query optimisation, caching, reducing model hydration)
- Profiling and debugging production systems
- Scaling applications used by thousands of active users

ACADEMIC TRANSCRIPT

Approved Qualification: Bachelor of Science in Mathematical Sciences
Qualification: BSc in MathSc in Mathematics&ComputerSc
Qualification Type: Bachelor's Degree (360 - NQF level 7) Level: NQF Level 7



Year	Module Code	Module Description	Final Mark	Result Description
2021	APM01A1	APPLIED MATHEMATICS 1A	84	PASSED WITH DISTINCTION
2021	APM01B1	APPLIED MATHEMATICS 1B	90	PASSED WITH DISTINCTION
2021	CSC01A1	COMPUTER SCIENCE 1A	87	PASSED WITH DISTINCTION
2021	CSC01B1	COMPUTER SCIENCE 1B	75	PASSED WITH DISTINCTION
2021	MAT01A1	MATHEMATICS 1A	86	PASSED WITH DISTINCTION
2021	MAT01B1	MATHEMATICS 1B	56	PASSED
2021	STA01A1	STATISTICS 1A	75	PASSED WITH DISTINCTION
2021	STA01B1	STATISTICS 1B	80	PASSED WITH DISTINCTION
2022	CSC02A2	COMPUTER SCIENCE 2A	75	PASSED WITH DISTINCTION
2022	CSC02B2	COMPUTER SCIENCE 2B	59	PASSED
2022	MAT01A2	MATHEMATICS 2A1	77	PASSED WITH DISTINCTION
2022	MAT01B2	MATHEMATICS 2B1	57	PASSED
2022	MAT02A2	MATHEMATICS 2A2	56	PASSED
2022	MAT02B2	MATHEMATICS 2B2	57	PASSED
2022	STA02A2	STATISTICS 2A	63	PASSED
2022	STA02B2	STATISTICS 2B	55	PASSED
2023	CSC03A3	COMPUTER SCIENCE 3A	70	PASSED
2023	CSC03B3	COMPUTER SCIENCE 3B	77	PASSED WITH DISTINCTION
2023	MAT01A3	MATHEMATICS 3A10	61	PASSED
2023	MAT01B3	MATHEMATICS 3B10	76	PASSED WITH DISTINCTION
2023	MAT02A3	MATHEMATICS 3A20	66	PASSED
2023	MAT02B3	MATHEMATICS 3B20	78	PASSED WITH DISTINCTION

UDEMY COURSES

The Data Science Course: Complete Data Science Bootcamp 2024

Date: June 19, 2024 **Length:** 32 hours

Bootstrap 5 From Scratch | Build 5 Modern Websites

Date: Mar 01, 2024 **Length:** 14 hours

The Complete 2023 Web Development Bootcamp

Date: May 02, 2023 **Length:** 63 hours

Django 3 - Full Stack Websites with Python Web Development

Date: May 15, 2020 **Length:** 9 hours

The Complete Python Bootcamp From Zero to Hero in Python

Date: Jan 03, 2020 **Length:** 22 hours